

פרשת וירא. If we look at the פרשה in the context of the parshiyos that surround it, there's a remarkable difference between the three פרשיות of לך לך, וירא, and חיי שרה. The first few words of לך לך are וַיֹּאמֶר ה' אֶל לך לך. The first three words of חיי שרה are וַיִּהְיוּ חַיֵּי שָׂרָה. However, פרשת וירא starts off without mentioning אברהם's name: וַיֵּרָא אֵלָיו ה' בְּאַלְנֵי מְרָא. That's a rather unusual way to start a פרשה. Who are we talking about? We're talking about אברהם. If you go back to the end of לך לך, אברהם's name is not even in the last pasuk, it's in second-to-last pasuk, בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה נָמוּל אֶבְרָהָם. Then it says וַיֵּרָא אֵלָיו. Why do we use a pronoun?

מנהג. The ספר, a wonderful ספר which I've quoted many times, brings down a fascinating מנהג. When a person is visiting a חולה, one should not say his name in his presence. He brings it down from the ילקוט ראובני, quoted in a sefer called 'סודי רזי'א. If someone goes in to visit a חולה, he should not mention him by name. He should say שלמה שלמה and ask "How are you? What can I do to help you? Let me help clean up the room a little bit." The רמב"ן writes that it's very important to help keep the place clean and neat, a visitor should make it his business to clean up the house, and that helps the חולה get better. In fact, there's a גמרא in עמוד א' that נדרים דף מ' עמוד א' גמרא, and people did not come to visit him. מְעַשֶּׂה בְּתַלְמִיד אֶחָד מִתְלַמְּדֵי רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא שְׁתֵּלָה that נדרים דף מ' עמוד א' גמרא, and people did not come to visit him. עקיבא came in to visit him, and he helped to clean him and clean the room, and the sick person said, "רַבִּי, הִתְיַיְתְּנִי". So there are a number of things you should do on a ביקור חולים visit. But one of the things you don't do is mention his name. And that's exactly what happens here, וַיֵּרָא אֵלָיו. It doesn't say וַיֵּרָא אֶל אַבְרָהָם to indicate that אברהם did not mention his name when he came to visit him.

The מגן אברהם writes in the name of the מהר"ל, a very early פוסק quoted in רש"י many times, that if someone is מבקש רחמים for his friend, you don't mention his name while in front of him. But if you're מתפלל while not in front of him, then you should mention his name. As we all know, we mention the name and the mother's name. The סופר חתם writes in מסכת נדרים that when a person mentions a חולה's name, there is a התעוררות of דין on him. Therefore, it's a הפסד to mention the sick person's name while in his presence.

Now, he brings another point from the ספר טעמי המנהגים that another possibility is that there may very well be a גזר against גזר דין, so it would be important not to mention his name at a ביקור חולים visit. In serious situations, one of the techniques we have to disrupt that is to change his name, because that the גזר against גזר דין is not the same thing as a גזר against גזר דין, for example. When we change the name, that גזר דין is no longer applicable to this person because this is a different person with a different name.

Now, another fascinating aspect of this brought down from the Munkatcher Rebbe, the זכותו יגן, and is mentioned in a number of ספרים of his descendants, is that when we make the שברך מי שברך for a חולה in shul, not to say the word החולה. We say מי שברך אבותינו אברהם יצחק ויעקב הוא יברך את, and the לשון in every סידור says החולה, and then they give the names. Rabbi Oelbaum quoted this a number of years ago, and we in our shul changed our מנהג to not say the word החולה, we don't want to label this person as a חולה. The sefer חיים ושלום brings that Chazal say in מסכת שבת that a person should always be מבקש רחמים that he should not get sick, and if, חס ושלום, someone does get sick, we say to him, הוי זכות והיפטר, Find a זכות. However, once we label him a חולה, we're being מקיים that this is his status. That's not a זכות, that's cementing him into that category of חולה. Therefore, it's an excellent suggestion to leave out the word when you say the שברך מי שברך, which we've done in our shul for many years. Whoever's גבאי who hears that, you're more than welcome to follow this מנהג or at least bring it up with your local Orthodox rabbi.

The point is a person's name is that person. We know that it's a very important ענין when a baby is born to give a name that's appropriate and will be a זכות for him. We don't want that same name חס ושלום to be a חובה to him. Therefore, if חס ושלום a situation happens where someone gets sick, we have to follow these



suggestions, and they will help them have a רפואה שלמה. All the חולים in ישראל should have a רפואה געזונט און שטארק and all the healthy people should stay healthy and be שלמה במהרה.



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